

World of Darkness — Setting Comparison & Ratings

Excludes Demon, Mummy & Wraith. Ranked by popularity + critical standing + thematic strength. Lines marked (oWoD) = Classic/Old World of Darkness · (CofD) = Chronicles of Darkness.

★★★★★ — 5/5

Vampire: The Masquerade (oWoD) The flagship. A newly-dead predator clings to humanity while clan politics and the Beast inside try to take it. Most popular line in the franchise; current **5th Edition (V5)**. *Themes: predator vs. person · addiction · power's cost · conspiracy · immortality as curse.*

★★★★½ — 4.5/5

Werewolf: The Apocalypse (oWoD) A shapeshifting holy warrior in a doomed last stand against corruption (the Wyrm) and ecological collapse. Rage, tribe, righteous war; current **5th Edition (W5)**. *Themes: eco-apocalypse · sacred duty · rage · spirit & flesh · inevitable loss.*

★★★★ — 4/5

Mage: The Ascension (oWoD) Reality is a consensus you can break. Your enlightened belief reshapes the world — with Paradox backlash — while the Technocracy enforces "normal." *Themes: belief vs. reality · free will vs. control · science vs. mysticism.*

Hunter: The Reckoning (oWoD / current 5e) An ordinary mortal who's seen the monsters and fights back — outgunned and possibly losing their mind. The most accessible modern entry point. *Themes: ordinary courage · paranoia · the cost of the crusade.*

★★★½ — 3.5/5

Vampire: The Requiem (CofD) The reboot of Vampire — cleaner mechanics, a build-your-own-metaplot sandbox. Often called the mechanically superior vampire game. *Themes: predation · conscience · politics · existential ambiguity.*

Mage: The Awakening (CofD) Atlantean sorcerers drawing on a fallen supernal world. More systematized and consistent than Ascension. *Themes: hubris · the seeker's curse · secrets & gnosis.*

Changeling: The Dreaming (oWoD) A faerie soul reborn in a mortal body, holding onto wonder (Glamour) against a gray world of disbelief (Banality). Whimsical, bittersweet, divisive. *Themes: wonder vs. cynicism · the death of childhood · art & dream.*

★★★ — 3/5

Changeling: The Lost (CofD) Abducted by inhuman Fae, you escaped after years of torment — and something wearing your face took your place. Dark, horror-forward. *Themes: trauma & recovery · captivity · stolen identity · the bargain's price.*

Werewolf: The Forsaken (CofD) Spirit-world police walking the border of flesh and spirit. Personal, local horror over doomed eco-war. *Themes: duty & territory · the hunt · family & pack.*

Hunter: The Vigil (CofD) Mortals facing the supernatural from neighborhood cells to global conspiracies. Flexible, tier-based. *Themes: knowledge as burden · escalation · defender to zealot.*

Promethean: The Created (CofD) An artificial human on a pilgrimage to earn a real soul — while your existence poisons the world around you. Tragic cult favorite. *Themes: what makes us human · alienation · redemption through*

suffering.

★★½ — 2.5/5

Geist: The Sin-Eaters (CofD) You died, bargained with a death-spirit to return, and now walk between the living and the restless dead. Greatly improved in 2nd Edition. *Themes: death & second chances · debts · unfinished business.*

Beast: The Primordial (CofD) You're a living primal nightmare, feeding on fear and kin to all monsters. The franchise's most controversial line. *Themes: the monster within · fear & hunger · self-justification.*

Deviant: The Renegades (CofD) The survivor of an experiment that Remade you — now hunting the Conspiracy that did it. Sharp revenge-thriller premise. *Themes: vengeance · found family · body horror · purpose vs. self-destruction.*